

**Board 1**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 2  
 ♥ 9 4 2  
 ♦ 9 7 4 3  
 ♣ K J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 3  
 ♥ A 8 6 5  
 ♦ 6 5  
 ♣ 10 7 6



♠ A 7 5 4  
 ♥ Q J  
 ♦ K Q 8 2  
 ♣ 9 4 2

♠ J 10 9  
 ♥ K 10 7 3  
 ♦ A J 10  
 ♣ A Q 5

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              | 1 ♦         | 1NT          |
| Pass         | 2 ♣          | Pass        | 2 ♥          |
| Pass         | 3 ♥          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3 ♥ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♠ 6    |              |             |              |

The bidding has been as shown.

You treat partner's 1NT Overcall the same as a 1NT Opening. You use Stayman and bid 2 ♣. Partner replies 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. You bid 3 ♥, inviting partner to go to game with a maximum. He declines your invitation.

**Board 2**

East Deals

None Vul

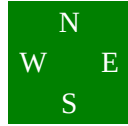
♠ Q 10 6  
 ♥ 8 7 6 5 3  
 ♦ 10 8 7 4  
 ♣ 5

♠ 8 4

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q 9 5

♣ K 9 7 2



♠ K 7 5 3 2

♥ A 2

♦ J 6 2

♣ A 8 4

♠ A J 9

♥ 10 9 4

♦ K 3

♣ Q J 10 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 10

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a sound 2-level overcall. You bid 2 ♣ and partner replies 2 ♠. What is your next bid?

Partner's cue-bid obviously forces you to bid.

Partner's hand might be very distributional, but rather than just sticking to ♣s you suggest with 2NT. This guarantees you have ♠s stopped. Partner likes your suggestion and bids 3NT.

**Board 3**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 6  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 10 5 4  
♣ A K 9 3

♠ K Q J 10 5

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A J 3

♣ 8 7



♠ 9 4 2  
♥ 8 5 4 2  
♦ 8 6 2  
♣ 5 4 2

♠ 8 3

♥ A J 9

♦ K Q 9 7

♣ Q J 10 6

The bidding has been as shown.

Balanced hand, poor support for partner's suit, stoppers in their suit and 13 points. You couldn't get a better hand to jump to 2NT. Partner takes you to 3NT.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♣          | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣K     |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 6 5  
 ♥ A 9 6 2  
 ♦ 3  
 ♣ A J 8 5 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K 8 5

♦ K Q 10 9 6 4

♣ 7 2



♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 2

♣ 6 4

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q 10 9

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♣          | 2 ♦   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3 ♥   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣5     |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

With a good 6-card suit and 10 points you make a Weak Jump Overcall to 2 ♦. Partner says 2NT.

The 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. It asks for the identification of any outside high-card if the Weak 2-bidder has more than a minimum. Here you are in the top range for your bid so you show your ♥K.

That was apparently the missing link for partner, he now says 3NT.

**Board 5**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 4  
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3  
 ♦ Q 10 8 4  
 ♣ Q 7

♠ A 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ K J 6

♣ 10 8 6 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 7

♥ Q 5

♦ 9 5 3 2

♣ A K J 5 3

♠ K Q 10 9 3 2

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1♣   | 2♠    |
| Pass        | 2NT   | Pass | 3♦    |
| Pass        | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥J    |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

You might just try 4♠. Of course if partner has a minimum Weak Jump Overcall that will get you much too high. A better approach is to ask for more information from partner. The bid that asks is 2NT. Partner replies 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ bid tells you two things. One, he is in the top half of his 6-11 point range. Two, he has a high card (Ace or King) in ♦s. When you construct a hand for him which contains 6 pretty good ♠s and the ♦A you come up with a hand which will probably make game. Bid 4♠.